Indus University

Civics & Community Engagement | Assignment 2

Assignment: 2nd
Subject: Civics & Community Engagement
Major: Computer Science

Instructor: Farha Sadia Quresh
Student ID: 436-2026

Name: Imama Mushtaq
Date: 26th Oct 2026

1 What are the social, cultural and political forces that impact communities?

A community does not change only because of what its own members decide. Forces from outside the individual shape how people live, mix and feel about where they belong. Three of the main ones are social, cultural and political forces. [1]

Source: [1] https://vce.studypulse.au/learn/SOC/economicsocialpoliticalgeographical_effects

- **Social forces:** These come from relationships, groups and institutions such as family, schools, migration and shared activities. Festivals, sport and shared meals build trust between people, while discrimination and isolation weaken it. [1]
- **Cultural forces:** These are the beliefs, values, language, religion and traditions of a group. They decide what people see as normal and give them a sense of belonging. Food, language and religious practice help a community keep its identity. [1]
- **Political forces:** These are laws, government decisions and policies. They decide who gets services, rights and a voice. Policies that welcome diversity tell communities they are valued, while neglect or exclusion pushes them away. [1]

Source: [1] https://vce.studypulse.au/learn/SOC/economicsocialpoliticalgeographical_effects

REAL-LIFE EXAMPLE Canada's multiculturalism policy (1971)

In October 1971 Prime Minister Pierre Trudeau announced multiculturalism as official policy. Canada was the first country in the world to adopt such a policy [2]. The government promised to help cultural groups develop, help people overcome discrimination, encourage exchange between cultures and help immigrants learn English or French [3]. One political decision changed the social and cultural life of communities across the country.

Source: [2] https://thecanadianencyclopedia.ca/en/article/multiculturalism
[3] https://pier21.ca/research/immigration-history/canadian-multiculturalism-policy-1971

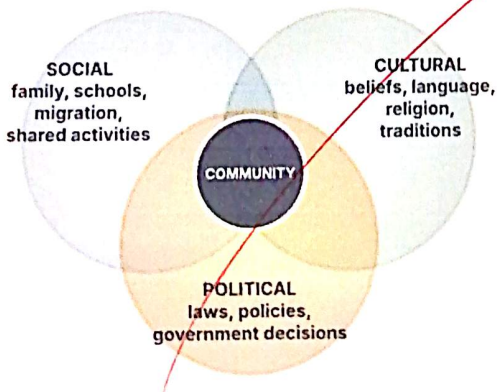


Diagram: social, cultural and political forces overlap on every community.



Figure 1: A Canada Day gathering in a city park, with Indigenous tipis and visitors sharing the same space.

Image source:
https://cdn.wisemove.ca/image/blog/7b9a8eade76c2629e040b287cda2fc7d.jpeg

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2 What are the political implications of these social, cultural and political forces on communities?

When social and cultural differences turn into political issues, the effects show up in laws, in voting and in how safe or accepted a community feels. Three implications stand out. [4][5]

Source: [4] https://hopenothate.org.uk/?p=11043
[5] https://www.research-live.com/article/news/identity-issues-emerge-as-new-leftright-divide-in-uk-politics-finds-bsa-/id/5126933

- **Polarisation:** Identity and immigration questions can split voters into opposing camps and weaken ties inside a community. [4]
- **Policy affects wellbeing:** Restrictive laws and hostile political talk create stress and fear for the communities they target. [6]
- **Voice in political life:** Groups that feel left out find it harder to take part and be heard. [1]

Source: [4] https://hopenothate.org.uk/?p=11043
[6] https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC9337836/
[1] https://vce.studyonline.au/learn/SOC/economicssocialpoliticalgeographical_effects

REAL-LIFE EXAMPLE Brexit in the United Kingdom (2016)

The EU referendum exposed divisions that already existed, with immigration as a key dividing issue. Leave appealed most to people who were sceptical about immigration and worried about cultural change [4]. The British Social Attitudes study (2024) found that culture and identity issues now sit next to the old left–right economic divide in shaping how people vote [5].

Source: [4] https://hopenothate.org.uk/?p=11043
[5] https://www.research-live.com/article/news/identity-issues-emerge-as-new-leftright-divide-in-uk-politics-finds-bsa-/id/5126933

REAL-LIFE EXAMPLE Latino communities in the United States

Stricter immigration policies since 2016 and the COVID-19 pandemic created new stress for Latino communities and raised the risk of mental health problems [6].

Source: [6] https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC9337836/

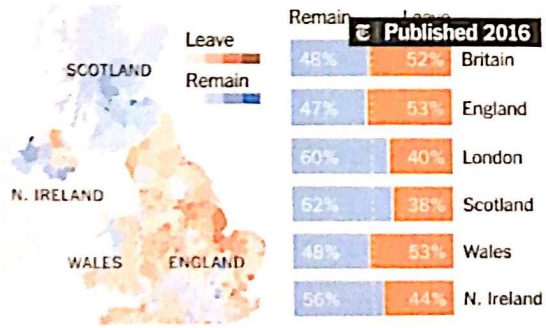


Figure 2: 2016 EU referendum results. Britain voted 48% Remain and 52% Leave, while Scotland voted 62% Remain and England 53% Leave. Source: The New York Times, 2016.

Image source: https://static01.nyt.com/images/2016/06/24/world/europe/how-britain-voted-brexit-referendum-1466746689036/how-britain-voted-brexit-referendum-1466746689036-videoSixteenByNine3000-v3.png?year=2016&h=1687&w=3000&s=25f9d2f1e1b8949229eb2bd4df7b9f83938e9eb380e71bdef0485124dcc05de0&k=ZQIBKqZ0VN&tw=1

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3 Define integration and marginality (marginalism) in a community or society.

tegration is the process in which newcomers or minorities are brought into the social structure of the society they live . It does not mean forced assimilation. It is usually measured through social networks, language and intermarriage.]

urce: [7] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Social_integration

arginality is the condition of being pushed to the edges of social life, with limited power, recognition and inclusion in e wider society. It often follows from race, religion, class or legal status. [8]

urce: [8] https://elearning.univ-tlemcen.dz/pluginfile.php/275519/mod_resource/content/1/social%20exclusion%20via%20social%20marginalization.pdf

	Integration	Marginality (Marginalisation)
Meaning	Newcomers or minorities are brought into the social structure of the society they live in.	A group is pushed to the edges of social life, with limited power, recognition and inclusion.
Result	Closer ties between groups, shared values and peaceful coexistence.	Poor access to services, rights and a voice in political life.
Example	Immigrants in Canada under its multiculturalism policy.	Rohingya in Myanmar after the 1982 Citizenship Law.

REAL-LIFE EXAMPLE **Integration: immigrants in Canada**

Researcher Will Kymlicka points out that about 93% of immigrants in Canada identify strongly or very strongly with the country, a rate much higher than in other countries. His reading is that multiculturalism has helped integration, not harmed it [9].

Source: [9] https://activehistory.ca/blog/2024/03/12/who-killed-the-history-of-canadian-multiculturalism/

REAL-LIFE EXAMPLE **Marginality: the Rohingya in Myanmar**

Myanmar's 1982 Citizenship Law gives full citizenship only to recognised national races and leaves out the Rohingya, which has made them effectively stateless [10]. As stateless people they struggle to reach healthcare, education, free movement and political participation [11].

Source: [10] https://www.refugeesinternational.org/?p=1551
[11] https://en.themooknayak.com/minority-news/the-rohingya-how-can-a-state-make-people-stateless



Figure 3: Shelters in a Rohingya refugee camp, where stateless families live after fleeing Myanmar.
Image source: https://www.japantimes.co.jp/japantimes/uploads/images/2024/11/25/436184.JPG

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4 Ritchhart identified eight cultural forces. What are they?

Ron Ritchhart is an educator and researcher who spent about 25 years at Project Zero, Harvard Graduate School of Education. In his book Creating Cultures of Thinking he explains that the culture of any group, whether a classroom, a school or an organisation, is shaped by eight cultural forces: expectations, language, time, modeling, opportunities, routines, interactions and environment. [12][13][14]

Source: [12] https://www.middleweb.com/31228/a-culture-of-thinking-can-transform-schools/
[13] https://www.nesacenter.org/uploaded/conferences/FLC/2016/handouts_specialists/Leading_a_CoT_MC_2016.pdf
[14] https://linc.gse.harvard.edu/event/linc-talk-11

Expectations	Beliefs about what learning and success should look like. They work like an internal compass for a group.
Language	The words a group uses point attention and action in a direction and carry hidden messages.
Time	How time is given or limited shows what the group really values.
Modeling	Leaders show what thinking and learning look like, openly or without saying it.
Opportunities	The chances people get to grow, think and take part.
Routines	Shared practices that make up a group's way of doing things.
Interactions	The relationships between people. Learning is a social activity.
Environment	How space is arranged and used to support thinking and learning.



Ritchhart's eight cultural forces

Source: [13] https://www.nesacenter.org/uploaded/conferences/FLC/2016/handouts_specialists/Leading_a_CoT_MC_2016.pdf
[12] https://www.middleweb.com/31228/a-culture-of-thinking-can-transform-schools/

REAL-LIFE EXAMPLE **Eight forces at work in classrooms**

Ritchhart's Cultures of Thinking work is applied in classrooms, schools and organisations. In one study, researchers observed teachers who deliberately shaped their language and routines so that students said their thinking out loud, which matches Ritchhart's ideas [15].

Source: [15] https://our.oakland.edu/items/c8e69ecc-15d4-4672-aa6b-bb389e65b6f7

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